

Proofreading V2 feedback – Feb 19 [updated]

Q1 – How you answer this question will gravely impact the remainder of the evaluation and your overall score in the cert.

i) *Yes, the text is grammatically correct and free of punctuation ambiguity.*

As most of the tasks in the cert are quite short phrases or sentences, this should be an easy to determine option. Do not get confused by short phrases just because they lack a period at the end.

Remember: check if the sentence is comprehensible and verify the approach of neutral/informal/formal texts. Refer to some examples below.

ii) *No, the text contains grammatical errors or punctuation that causes ambiguity.*

This is when the text has obvious grammatical, spelling errors or if an abbreviation that should be expanded is used. The tricky part is determining the “punctuation” ambiguity. Note that this can be determined, usually, by an obvious lack of comma where it’s clearly needed (e.g. listing of things, which occurs in some sentences) or potentially a lack of a period/full stop between sentences.

iii) *The meaning of the text cannot be determined because the text is so poorly constructed or lacks sufficient context.*

This option will only be used if the **entire** input text is incomprehensible. You won’t be needing this option too much in the cert. There is task in the cert with the exact example from the GLs being used, and yet a lot of people did not select this option. There is at least one other obvious example of a short sentence listing multiple names ‘persona’.

Correctness

Focus point - **only** the **edits made**

- Whether you think the input has issues or not, you should only check whether the assistant made any changes.
- If it has, only evaluate the actual edits and whether they have been necessary (an issue had to be fixed) or unnecessary (the input was already good).
- Question 3.1 (input has no issues, assistant made changes): check whether the actual change affects the meaning, tone, style. Remember that not every change affects this. Removing periods, question/exclamation marks does not affect it. Changing “can’t” to “cannot”, and other exact matching words, does not change it. However, changing actual words, sentence structure, fluidity and style would be affecting this question.
- Question 3.2 (input has issues, assistant made changes): check which issues had to be fixed (necessary) and which didn’t have to be fixed (unnecessary). If there is a mix, select “mixed” and then evaluate the additional questions individually for each separate group of issues (necessary vs unnecessary). Do not mix these up.

Completeness

Focus point - the **actual** errors in the input (found and fixed)

- Do not get influenced by the edits made; focus on the actual errors present in the input and whether they have been corrected.

- People are getting distracted by edits being made even though they are unnecessary.
- Evaluate the input and identify the actual errors in the comprehensive text and then check the response to see if they have been identified and fixed by the assistant.
- If even one error was missed by the assistant (not detected at all or wrongly corrected), it should fail this dimension.
E.g. Input says "I need to get to the ATm to pick up some cash."
Proofread response: "I need to get to the atm to pick up some cash."
Actual error: "ATm"
Assistant identified error – yes
Assistant fixed it correctly – no
The correction should have been ATM (Automatic Teller Machine) given the clear context. "atm" means 'at the moment' and would be wrong in lower-case.
- **If** the assistant introduces a new error, that's penalized under Correctness. That is, the input was already good and the proofread made a change that created a new error.

EXAMPLES

"This is hard the who pays bit"

Many evaluated Q1 wrongly even though this is a direct example from the guides.

"Loved an image"

This task appears twice. The input does not contain any issues even if it sounds strange without context. It's not grammatically incorrect. However, when you change it to "loved **the** image", it does change the tone, style, register, meaning because "an image" is one of many; "the image" is a specific one.

"Didn't bring wallet or anything"

This one confused a lot of people, understandably. The letter in the text is a lower case "l" and not an upper case "I", the text is comprehensible either way. The fact that the assistant removes this in the edit does not actually change the meaning/style/tone.

"Which cars? Accord or Lawrencemouth?"

This task should **not** be labeled as "the meaning cannot be determined". Remember that the entire input needs to be incomprehensible in order to use this option.

"I think you care about the bureaucracy part. (continued)" - task

This task appears twice, so evaluate it carefully. If you made the wrong initial evaluation, you'll get it wrong on both tasks. A common issue people won't notice is that "listserve" should be "listserv".

"My delivery address is xxx...soo"

This is somewhat informal text and it's comprehensive. If in this case the assistant decides to change the punctuation or remove one "o" to "so", then this does **not** affect the meaning/tone/style.

Hi Sneha! Lunch tomorrow???	Hi, Sneha, Lunch tomorrow?	No, none of the edits altered the original meaning, tone, style, or register.
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And this guy on *Blue* actually looks like Dwayne *Johnson*, the *wrestler*.

This is a perfect example of separating Correctness eval with Completeness eval. In correctness, focus on the actual changes the assistant made. Was it necessary to capitalize Blue here or not? In Completeness, you focus on the actual errors and whether they were found and fixed. If you answered that “Blue” was not a necessary change, then that means it was not an error to begin with, and you ignore it in the Completeness eval. However, if “on” should have been changed to “in” then that’s an error the assistant may have missed and that affects Completeness, but not Correctness (as it hasn’t edited that part).

Russian ‘Spartacus’ volleyball club history task

This is the longest input text of all the tasks in the cert, containing a lot of mistakes. We believe that this task was specifically introduced to test this scenario below. Pay careful attention to each sentence, and split them between comprehensible (with or without errors and punctuation ambiguity) and completely incomprehensible. Then only evaluate the comprehensible part.

2. The input contains both comprehensible and ambiguous

- It's possible that the input text is long (ex: a paragraph) and can contain sections that are understandable and assessable, alongside other parts that are too vague or unclear to evaluate.
- **Expectation for Assistant:** The assistant is expected to edit the part that's comprehensible and treats the ambiguous part as if it contains no error.
-  **Action for you to take for Q1 Is the input text grammatically correct and free of punctuation ambiguity? :**
 - **Focus on the Comprehensible Parts:** Evaluate the grammatical correctness and punctuation ambiguity only within the parts of the text that you can clearly understand.
 - **Treat Ambiguous Parts as "No Error":** For the purpose of this assessment, disregard the ambiguous parts when looking for errors. They are treated as if they contain no grammatical errors or punctuation ambiguity.
- **Important:** Choose Based on Comprehensible Parts:
 - Select **"Yes"** if the comprehensible parts are grammatically correct and free of punctuation ambiguity.
 - Select **"No"** if the comprehensible parts contain clear grammatical errors or punctuation that creates ambiguity.

“Like I can’t even go anywhere, other than college and work to get away either (...)” - task

Just because the model made no changes/edits, it does not mean the input is perfect. This example contained a few “like” inserted as discourse markers. The entire input is comprehensible but it has ambiguity due to the punctuation missing, e.g. “Like, I can’t even go anywhere...” is the appropriate way.

“Dear Sam I will be visiting Isreal (...) I have booked a hotel at Batmore...I will visit Jerusalem city...and see the the Manjar”

For those who selected “yes, the input has no issues”, please be more attentive on the tasks in general. This specific task had very obvious issues that could have been identified even when comparing against the proofread response.

For those of you that identified the errors, never assume that every edit is automatically necessary. Most of you failed to identify that some edits were unnecessary. “City” in Jerusalem city did not have to be capitalized. “Batmore” and “Manjar” may not have to be changed because we cannot verify what these are and the corrections don’t seem to be valid either. Hence, in such cases we err on the side of keeping the original.

“Go get it before you come??” → Go get it before you come?

Please read the guidelines and this feedback thoroughly. This scenario is clearly covered in the guidelines. If you have selected Q1 as “yes, error free”, it makes no sense to answer Q3 as “yes, the changes were necessary”, which is how the vast majority answered. You have selected that the input is already good, which means any changes that occur would be unnecessary.

“173 S Birch Place”

There is nothing wrong with this input, it’s a common address format. If you’re not sure, a quick search would have given you the confirmation.

“William Ramos? .)”

Majority answered this one as having issues, but the text itself does not have issues and there’s no punctuation that causes ambiguity to it. Yes, the symbols might look odd (smiley attempt failed), but it does not cause the text to be ambiguous or incomprehensible.

General word of advice – the third option for Q1 would not be commonly used in the cert itself. There are a couple of examples in each cert but some are using it a lot more than it’s actually needed. If you see what appears as a strange input, ask yourself whether adding punctuation would make the content clearer and comprehensible.